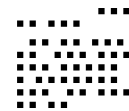
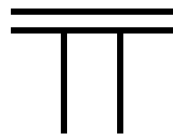
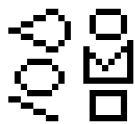


WANDERING



A BRIEF BEGINNERS GUIDE



BY JONAH

"Wandering" is exploring a place (a city, a village, a stretch of nature) without normal directions, and without a plan to go somewhere in particular. Often a wander will follow a set of rules for how to explore, usually by walking. It can be done alone or in any size group

This is based on practices originally from SI (situationists) and *Guy Debord* (french guy), but with many many other schools, permutations and traditions, ranging the full spectrum of academic to colloquial practices

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Each version of wandering that exists generally has its own explanations for why someone would want to wander. Debord's original theory of *Dérive* is centrally political in nature. Many forms of wandering simply aim to change the way that we see our surroundings, by treating them differently. It's rare to intentionally travel for a long time without a destination, and doing so can make you think about a space differently. I mostly like to wander as a way to reset myself. It's a way to temporarily visit another way of doing things, one that's slow and attentive, trying to get nowhere

Wandering can be sort of a form of meditation or trance. You will likely feel bored at times. Try to focus on observing and attending to every facet of the environment. Try to sink into it, experience its colors, sounds, smells, in full. Imagine that what you're seeing is a scene in a movie, lend it your attention as if it were. And let go of the urge to feel anything specific or interesting - just try to be as aware of your surroundings as possible. If you are leading or choosing where to go, don't worry about going the right way, there is no right way

Common rules for my wander include no talking, no looking at phones, listening to shared music, and switching off leading the walk. These are not unique to me, and are common practices across a lot of contemporary wanders. I also often wander with smaller groups, 1-3 people, and I usually wander in a city or in odd urban adjacent areas. Picking somewhere unfamiliar to the participants is usually a good idea. Using some set of rules is generally key, even if they are as simple as how to switch off leaders and setting a time limit.



